BOTÂNORA

N° 07



Backyard Herbs

Growing, harvesting and drying Brazilian herbs

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Backyard Herbs

Growing, harvesting, drying and brewing tea herbs

Many people have a tea pharmacy in their backyard or on their windowsill without knowing it. This guide teaches you to recognise, grow, harvest, dry and brew twenty-two herbs found in many Brazilian homes, with ten recipes to use the harvest, with what tradition says about each and the cautions science recommends.

Herbal tea is a drink, not a medicine. The uses described are traditional and do not replace diagnosis or treatment by a health professional.



01

Identify carefully

Common names mislead; check the scientific name.

02

Start with a pot

Five easy herbs give tea all year round.

03

Read the cautions

Natural does not mean harmless.

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CHAPTER I

Growing

From pot to bed

Aromatic herbs are generous: with sun, good drainage and frequent harvesting, they grow more the more you use them. You do not need a backyard; a sunny window is enough to start.

01 Pot basics
02 Harvest calendar



CHAPTER I

Pot basics

Four things decide whether a herb thrives: light, drainage, watering and pruning.

Light

4 to 6 h of sun

Most aromatic herbs are Mediterranean and want direct sun. Mint and lemon balm tolerate part shade. In the southern hemisphere a north-facing window gets the most sun.

Drainage

What kills herbs most

A pot with a hole, a layer of expanded clay or gravel at the bottom and a light mix: topsoil, coarse sand and worm castings in equal parts.

Watering

Finger in the soil

Water when the top 2 cm are dry. Rosemary and thyme like to dry out more; mint and basil, less.

Pruning

Harvesting is pruning

Always cut just above a pair of leaves: the plant branches out and fills in. Never take more than a third at once.

Five herbs to start with

HERB	MINIMUM POT	LIGHT	HOW TO START
Mint	20 cm	part shade	seedling or a sprig rooted in water
Lemongrass	30 cm	full sun	clump division
Lemon balm	20 cm	part shade	seedling
Rosemary	25 cm	full sun	10 cm cutting
Basil	20 cm	full sun	seed or seedling

BOTÂNORA TIP

Sprigs of mint, basil and bushy lippia root in a glass of water in 7 to 10 days. It is the cheapest way to multiply them.

CHAPTER I

Harvest calendar

For southern and south-eastern Brazil. In the north and north-east, the heat allows planting almost all year, but avoid the peak of the rains.

HERB	PLANTING	BEST HARVEST	TIME OF DAY
Chamomile	Mar—May	open flowers, Jul—Oct	dry morning
Mint	all year	before flowering	morning
Lemon balm	Aug—Oct	spring and summer	morning
Lemongrass	Sep—Nov	summer and autumn	any
Basil	Sep—Feb	summer, before flowers	morning
Rosemary	all year	all year	late morning
Fennel	Mar—May	seeds dry on the plant	dry afternoon
Roselle	Oct—Dec	red calyces, Apr—Jun	morning
Ginger	Aug—Oct	leaves yellowing, May—Jul	any
Macela	native	flowers, Mar—Apr	dry morning

Why in the morning

Essential oils are most concentrated in the leaves after the dew dries and before the strong sun. Picked in the midday heat, herbs lose aroma and wilt faster.

CHAPTER II

Fourteen herbs

Profiles, brewing and cautions

For each herb: the scientific name (the only one that does not mislead), the traditional use, how to brew it, the flavour, how to grow it and the main caution. Use it as a starting point, not as a prescription.

01 Lemongrass
02 Lemon balm
03 Lippia (bushy lippia)
04 Mint
05 Chamomile
06 Macela
07 Brazilian boldo
08 Rosemary
09 Basil
10 Fennel
11 Ginger
12 Guaco
13 Nasturtium
14 Hibiscus



Lemongrass

Cymbopogon citratus

Traditionally used as a mild calmative and digestive, at night or after meals.

BREW	Chopped leaves, steep 5–7 min at 95 °C
FLAVOUR	sweet lemon, grass
GROWING	Full sun, big pot or bed. Cut close to the clump.
CAUTION	Safe for most; avoid excess in pregnancy.

Lemon balm

Melissa officinalis

Used to relax, ease mild anxiety and help sleep.

BREW	Fresh leaves, steep 5–8 min at 90 °C, covered
FLAVOUR	soft lemon, mint
GROWING	Part shade, regular watering. Prefers mild climates.
CAUTION	May enhance sedatives; caution with hypothyroidism.

Lippia (bushy lippia)

Lippia alba

Brazil's most common "cidreira", used as a calmative and for the stomach.

BREW	Leaves, steep 5 min at 95 °C
FLAVOUR	lemon and light oregano
GROWING	Hardy shrub, sun or part shade. Roots easily from cuttings.
CAUTION	Use in moderation; some varieties are much stronger.

Mint

Mentha spp.

A classic for digestion, mild nausea and refreshment.

BREW	Fresh leaves, steep 5 min at 90 °C
FLAVOUR	menthol, sweet
GROWING	Part shade and lots of water. Plant alone: it takes over the pot.
CAUTION	May worsen reflux in some people.

Chamomile

Matricaria chamomilla

The herb of sleep and digestive comfort, also for older children.

BREW	Dried flowers, steep 5–10 min at 95 °C, covered
FLAVOUR	apple, honey, hay
GROWING	Sun, mild climate; sow in autumn in southern Brazil.
CAUTION	Avoid if allergic to the daisy family.

Macela

Achyrocline satureioides

A plant native to southern Brazil, used for digestion and mild cramps. Traditionally picked on Good Friday.

BREW	Dried flowers, steep 5 min at 95 °C
FLAVOUR	resinous chamomile
GROWING	Open field, poor dry soil. Hard in pots.
CAUTION	Avoid in pregnancy.

Brazilian boldo

Plectranthus barbatus

Widely used after overindulging, for the liver and digestion.

BREW	1–2 leaves crushed in cold water or a short steep
FLAVOUR	very bitter
GROWING	Sun or part shade; thick velvety leaves.
CAUTION	Short use only (a few days). Not in pregnancy, breastfeeding or for children.

Rosemary

Salvia rosmarinus

Associated with alertness and memory; warming on cold days.

BREW	Fresh sprig, steep 5 min at 95 °C
FLAVOUR	resinous, pine
GROWING	Full sun and little water. Hates waterlogging.
CAUTION	Moderation with high blood pressure and in pregnancy.

Basil

Ocimum basilicum

Used for digestion and, in forms like tulsi, as a balancing tea.

BREW	Fresh leaves, steep 4 min at 90 °C
FLAVOUR	aniseed, clove
GROWING	Sun, heat and frequent watering. Pinch flowers to get more leaves.
CAUTION	Safe in cooking and as an occasional tea.

Fennel

Foeniculum vulgare

Wind, cramps and digestion; popular after lunch.

BREW	Lightly crushed seeds, steep 8 min at 95 °C
FLAVOUR	sweet anise
GROWING	Sun, deep soil. Grows tall; prefer a bed.
CAUTION	Do not give to babies without medical advice.

Ginger

Zingiber officinale

Nausea, digestion and warmth; the base of many blends.

BREW	Sliced rhizome, simmer 5–10 min
FLAVOUR	spicy, citrus
GROWING	Plant a sprouted piece in a deep pot, part shade. Harvest in 8 to 10 months.
CAUTION	Caution with anticoagulants and gallstones.

Guaco

Mikania glomerata

Traditional in home syrups for cough and throat.

BREW	Leaves, steep 10 min at 95 °C
FLAVOUR	herbal, light vanilla
GROWING	A climber: needs a fence or trellis. Part shade.
CAUTION	Contains coumarin: avoid with anticoagulants, in pregnancy and for long periods.

Nasturtium

Tropaeolum majus

Edible flower and leaf, peppery; used more in cooking than in tea.

BREW	Flowers in cold infusions and salads
FLAVOUR	watercress, pepper
GROWING	Hardy, sun, poor soil. Flowers freely.
CAUTION	Safe as food.

Hibiscus

Hibiscus sabdariffa

Rich in anthocyanins; widely used in iced teas and as a tart drink.

BREW	Dried calyces, steep 5–10 min at 95 °C
FLAVOUR	cranberry, tart
GROWING	Roselle: sun, heat, annual cycle. Pick the red calyces.
CAUTION	May lower blood pressure; caution with antihypertensives and in pregnancy.

CHAPTER II

Names that mislead

The same common name can mean different plants from one region to another.

COMMON NAME	MAY BE	HOW TO TELL
"Erva-cidreira"	Melissa officinalis, Lippia alba or lemongrass	Melissa: soft leaf, low-growing. Lippia: woody shrub. Lemongrass: long thin blades.
Boldo	Brazilian boldo, Bahian boldo or Chilean boldo	The Chilean one (Peumus boldus) is sold dried and is more toxic in excess.
Erva-doce	Fennel or green anise	Fennel: larger striped seed. Anise: smaller and more aromatic.
Hortelã	Peppermint, spearmint, Cuban oregano	Cuban oregano has a thick leaf and smells of oregano.
Camomila	German or Roman chamomile	German chamomile has a hollow centre when cut in half.

GOLDEN RULE

Never pick herbs by roadsides, on wasteland or where pesticides are used. And never consume a plant you have not identified with certainty.

CHAPTER III

Harvest, dry, store

For tea all year round

Fresh herbs have more scent; dried ones are handier and more concentrated. Drying well is what separates an aromatic tea from one that tastes of straw.

01 Drying without a dehydrator

02 Storing and dosing



CHAPTER III

Drying without a dehydrator

Three home methods, from slowest to fastest.

Hanging bunches

7 to 14 days

Small bunches tied at the stem, upside down, somewhere dry, airy and out of direct sun. A paper bag with holes keeps dust off.

IDEAL FOR rosemary, mint, lemon balm

Screen or rack

3 to 7 days

Loose leaves and flowers in a single layer on a sieve or clean mosquito screen. Turn once a day.

IDEAL FOR chamomile, flowers, hibiscus

Low oven

1 to 3 hours

At the lowest setting (up to 50 °C), door ajar, tray lined with baking paper. Check every 30 minutes.

IDEAL FOR humid days, sliced ginger

How to tell it is dry

- The leaf crumbles between your fingers and the stem snaps.
- The colour stays green. Black or brown leaves dried too slowly or went mouldy.
- The scent is concentrated, not gone.

NOT RECOMMENDED

Avoid the microwave: it heats unevenly, cooks the leaf and can catch fire. Direct sun also burns off the aromatic oils.

CHAPTER III

Storing and dosing

Well-stored dried herbs keep their aroma for 6 to 12 months.

1. **Dark glass or tins**, tightly closed, away from the stove and light.
2. **Whole leaves** keep their aroma longer. Crumble only when using.
3. **Label** with name, scientific name and date.
4. **A silica sachet** helps in humid regions.

Fresh or dried: how much to use

FOR 250 ML	FRESH	DRIED
Leaves (mint, lemon balm)	8–10 leaves or 1 heaped tbsp chopped	1 heaped tsp (≈ 1.5 g)
Lemongrass	2 leaves, chopped	1 tbsp (≈ 2 g)
Flowers (chamomile)	2 tbsp	1 tbsp (≈ 2 g)
Roots (ginger)	4–5 slices	½ tsp powder or 4 dried slices
Seeds (fennel)	–	1 tsp crushed

BOTÂNORA TIP

The rule of thumb is 3 to 1: three times as much fresh herb as dried for the same flavour.

Infusion or decoction

Leaves and flowers are infused: hot water, heat off, vessel covered so the oils stay in. Roots, bark and hard seeds need a decoction: a gentle simmer of 5 to 10 minutes.

CHAPTER IV

Safety and blends

Natural, responsibly

Medicinal plants contain active substances. That is why they work, and that is why they call for care. Before the blends, the rules that apply to every herb.

01 Essential cautions

02 Six backyard blends



CHAPTER IV

Essential cautions

1. **Pregnancy, breastfeeding and young children:** avoid medicinal teas without advice. Boldo, macela, guaco, rue and wormwood are among those to avoid.
2. **Ongoing medication:** anticoagulants, antidepressants, antihypertensives, sedatives and hormones can interact with herbs. Tell your doctor what you drink.
3. **Limited duration:** teas taken for a therapeutic purpose are usually used for days or a few weeks, with breaks.
4. **One new herb at a time:** that way you notice allergies or discomfort.
5. **A symptom that persists is a sign to seek help**, not to double the dose.

Plants that should not become tea

PLANT	WHY
Comfrey	Alkaloids that can harm the liver; internal use not recommended
Rue	Toxic, can cause miscarriage; traditional use is external only
Dumb cane, oleander	Toxic ornamentals, sometimes confused with herbs
Wormwood in excess	Thujone, neurotoxic in high doses

> EMERGENCY
> If an unknown plant is swallowed by accident, seek medical care and bring a sample of the plant.

CHAPTER IV

Six backyard blends

N° 01

Bay & Orange

For after a heavy meal.

2 SERVINGS

3	dried bay leaves
1 strip	orange peel
½	cinnamon stick
500 ml	water

Simmer everything 5 min, cover and wait 5 more. Strain.

N° 02

Calendula & Lemongrass

Golden, citrusy and gentle.

2 SERVINGS

1 tbsp	calendula petals
2 leaves	chopped lemongrass
500 ml	water at 95 °C

Steep 7 min covered.

N° 03

Thyme & Honey

The garden throat tea.

1 MUG

2 sprigs	fresh thyme
250 ml	boiling water
1 tsp	honey

Steep the thyme 7 min covered. Strain and sweeten once warm.

N° 04

Iced garden

Mint, basil and lime.

1 L

1 sprig	mint
6 leaves	basil
1	lime, sliced
1 L	cold water

Fridge for 4 h. Strain before 8 h.

N° 05

Winter morning

Rosemary, orange and cinnamon.

2 SERVINGS

1 small sprig	rosemary
1 strip	orange peel
½	cinnamon stick
500 ml	water

Simmer the cinnamon 3 min, turn off, add the rest and cover 5 min.

N° 06

Backyard ruby

Hibiscus, lemongrass and apple.

1 L

2 tbsp	hibiscus
2 leaves	lemongrass
½	apple, sliced
1 L	water at 95 °C

Steep 8 min. Serve hot or iced.

CHAPTER V

Backyard recipes

Teas, syrups, salts and vinegars

Ten recipes to use the whole harvest: hot and iced teas, syrups, herb salt and butter and an infused vinegar. All with storage explained.

01 Lemongrass & Passion Fruit
02 Moroccan Mint Tea
03 Lavender & Lemon Honey
04 Backyard Herb Salt
05 Lemongrass Syrup
06 Basil & Strawberry Water
07 Fennel and Apple
08 Mint & Lime Shaved Ice
09 Herb Butter
10 Herb-infused Vinegar



01 Lemongrass & Passion Fruit

Hot, citrusy and tropical.

Hot · 10 min · 1 pot · 500 ml · Caffeine-free · Easy

INGREDIENTS

3 leaves	fresh lemongrass
1	passion fruit (pulp with seeds)
500 ml	water at 95 °C
1 tsp	honey

METHOD

1. Snip the lemongrass into 2 cm pieces.
2. Steep with the passion fruit pulp for 7 min, covered.
3. Strain and sweeten once warm.

BARISTA TIP Snipping the lemongrass (rather than crushing) keeps the scent without a grassy taste.

02 Moroccan Mint Tea

Gunpowder green, fresh mint and plenty of ritual.

Hot · 10 min · 1 pot · 500 ml · Caffeinated · Intermediate

INGREDIENTS

1 tbsp	gunpowder green tea
1 bunch	fresh mint
500 ml	boiling water
2 tbsp	sugar (optional)

Finish. Small glasses.

METHOD

1. Rinse the tea with 100 ml of boiling water for 30 s and discard (removes bitterness).
2. Add the mint, sugar and the rest of the water. Steep 4 min.
3. Pour from high up to form foam and return the first glass to the pot. Repeat twice.

BARISTA TIP Pouring from a height mixes the sugar and cools the tea to drinking temperature.

03 Lavender & Lemon Honey

Flavoured honey for teas, toast and yoghurt.

Hot · 10 min + 1 week · 1 jar · 250 g · Caffeine-free · Easy

INGREDIENTS

250 g	runny honey
1 tbsp	dried culinary lavender
1	lemon peel strips, dried for 1 day

METHOD

1. Put the lavender and dried peel in a scalded jar.
2. Cover with warm (not hot) honey and close.
3. Leave 1 week, turning the jar daily. Strain if you like.

BARISTA TIP Use only dry ingredients: moisture makes honey ferment. Never give honey to children under 1 year.

04 Backyard Herb Salt

Rosemary, thyme and sage for meat and vegetables.

Hot · 15 min + 1 day · 1 jar · 200 g · Caffeine-free · Easy

INGREDIENTS

1 cup	fresh rosemary, thyme and sage leaves
2	garlic cloves
150 g	coarse salt
1	lime zest

METHOD

1. Chop the herbs and garlic with half the salt into a damp paste.
2. Mix in the rest of the salt and the zest.
3. Spread on a tray and air-dry 24 h, or 1 h at 60 °C. Store in a jar.

BARISTA TIP The salt dries the herbs and keeps the aroma for months. A great gift.

05 Lemongrass Syrup

To sweeten iced teas, lemonades and drinks.

Hot · 20 min · 1 bottle · 300 ml · Caffeine-free · Easy

INGREDIENTS

200 g	sugar
200 ml	water
6 leaves	chopped lemongrass

METHOD

1. Dissolve the sugar in the water over low heat.
2. Add the lemongrass, simmer 2 min and turn off.
3. Cover for 1 h, strain and bottle.

BARISTA TIP Keeps 2 weeks in the fridge. Swap the lemongrass for mint, basil or rosemary.

06 Basil & Strawberry Water

Flavoured water for the whole day.

Iced · 5 min + 2 h · 1 jug · 1 L · Caffeine-free · Easy

INGREDIENTS

6	sliced strawberries
8 leaves	basil
1 L	cold filtered water

METHOD

1. Slap the basil in your palm to release the aroma.
2. Combine in the jug and chill for 2 h.
3. Drink the same day.

BARISTA TIP Great for anyone wanting to drink more water: flavour without sugar or caffeine.

07 Fennel and Apple

Naturally sweet, for after lunch.

Hot · 10 min · 2 cups · Caffeine-free · Easy

INGREDIENTS

1 tsp	crushed fennel seeds
½	apple, cubed, skin on
400 ml	water
1	small cinnamon stick

METHOD

1. Simmer the apple and cinnamon for 5 min.
2. Turn off, add the fennel and cover for 5 min.
3. Strain. Eat the apple cubes with a spoon.

BARISTA TIP Crushing the seeds in a mortar releases the oil: the flavour doubles.

08 Mint & Lime Shaved Ice

An icy garden dessert.

Iced · 10 min + 4 h · 4 glasses · Caffeine-free · Easy

INGREDIENTS

1 bunch	mint
400 ml	boiling water
80 g	sugar
2	limes (juice)

Finish. Small mint leaves.

METHOD

1. Steep the mint with the sugar in the water for 10 min, covered.
2. Strain, add the lime and cool.
3. Freeze in a shallow tray, scraping with a fork every 30 min.

BARISTA TIP A hot infusion pulls more aroma than blended raw mint, and does not turn dark.

09 Herb Butter

For bread, grills and vegetables.

Hot · 10 min · 1 log · 120 g · Caffeine-free · With milk · Easy

INGREDIENTS

100 g	room-temperature butter
3 tbsp	chopped fresh herbs (parsley, basil, thyme)
1	grated garlic clove
1 pinch	salt and lime zest

METHOD

1. Mix everything with a fork.
2. Roll in cling film into a log.
3. Chill for 1 h. Slice into rounds.

BARISTA TIP Keeps 1 week in the fridge and 3 months frozen. A great way to use herbs before they wilt.

10 Herb-infused Vinegar

For salads, with the scent of the garden.

Hot · 10 min + 2 weeks · 1 bottle · 500 ml · Caffeine-free · Easy

INGREDIENTS

500 ml	white wine or cider vinegar
3 sprigs	rosemary, thyme or tarragon, air-dried for 1 day
1 strip	lime peel

METHOD

1. Wash and dry the herbs very thoroughly.
2. Put them in a scalded bottle and cover with vinegar.
3. Leave 2 weeks in the dark, strain and re-bottle.

BARISTA TIP Vinegar is safe for preserving herbs. Oil with fresh herbs or garlic, by contrast, can develop botulism outside the fridge.

MORE HERBS AND THE GARDEN

Eight more herbs

Lavender

Lavandula angustifolia

Relaxation and aroma; used in small amounts.

BREW	3 to 5 buds per cup, 5 min
GROWING	Full sun and dry soil; prefers cool climates.
CAUTION	May add to sedatives; avoid high doses in pregnancy.

Calendula

Calendula officinalis

Colourful petals for teas and blends; traditional for the skin.

BREW	1 tbsp petals, 7 min
GROWING	Sun, mild winter; seeds easily.
CAUTION	Daisy-family allergy; avoid in pregnancy.

Thyme

Thymus vulgaris

Traditional for throat and mild cough.

BREW	1 sprig, 5 min, covered
GROWING	Sun and little water; great in pots.
CAUTION	Safe in cooking; avoid high doses in pregnancy.

Sage

Salvia officinalis

Throat and digestion; strong, resinous flavour.

BREW	3 leaves, 5 min
GROWING	Sun, well-drained soil.
CAUTION	Contains thujone: short use only; avoid in pregnancy, breastfeeding and epilepsy.

Bay laurel

Laurus nobilis

Digestive, popular after heavy meals.

BREW	2 dried leaves, simmer 5 min
GROWING	A big-pot shrub; grows slowly.
CAUTION	Safe in culinary use.

Espinheira-santa

Maytenus ilicifolia

Native to southern Brazil, traditional for heartburn and the stomach.

BREW	1 tbsp leaves, 10 min
GROWING	A part-shade shrub, slow-growing.
CAUTION	Avoid in pregnancy and breastfeeding.

Carqueja

Baccharis trimera

Bitter, digestive, typical of southern Brazil.

BREW	1 tsp, 5 min
GROWING	Open ground, sun and poor soil.
CAUTION	May lower blood sugar; avoid in pregnancy and with diabetes medication.

Turmeric

Curcuma longa

The base of golden milk; colour and earthy flavour.

BREW	2 cm grated, simmer 8 min
GROWING	Like ginger: rhizome in a deep pot.
CAUTION	Caution with anticoagulants and gallstones.

MORE HERBS AND THE GARDEN

A 1 m² tea garden

One bed or four big pots give a family tea all year round.

QUADRANT (50 × 50 CM)	PLANTS	WHY
North (most sun)	rosemary, thyme, lavender	Mediterranean: sun and dry soil
East (morning sun)	basil, chamomile, calendula	Like sun, not extreme heat
West (afternoon sun)	lemongrass, fennel	Heat-tolerant; grow tall
South (most shade)	mint (in a sunken pot), lemon balm	Prefer moisture and part shade

Setting up

1. Choose a spot with at least 4 h of direct sun.
2. Loose soil: 1 part earth, 1 compost, 1 coarse sand.
3. Plant the mint inside a bottomless pot sunk into the ground: it will not take over.
4. Mulch the soil with straw: less watering and fewer weeds.

> **BOTÂNORA TIP**
> In the southern hemisphere, north and west faces get the most sun. In a flat, a north-facing window is best.

MORE HERBS AND THE GARDEN

Propagating plants

Three techniques cover almost every herb in this guide, without buying new plants.

Cutting

rosemary, mint, lemon balm, basil, sage, bushy lippia

Cut a 10 cm flowerless stem, strip the lower leaves and put it in water or damp sand. Roots in 2 to 4 weeks.

Division

lemongrass, chives, mint

Lift the clump, separate it by hand or with a knife into rooted parts and replant at once. Best in spring.

Seed

chamomile, calendula, basil, fennel

Sow shallow in trays, keep moist and transplant at 4 true leaves. Chamomile: seed on the surface, it needs light.

Propagation calendar

SEASON	WHAT TO DO
Spring (Sep–Nov)	Divide clumps, take cuttings of almost everything, sow basil
Summer (Dec–Feb)	Cuttings in water, harvest and dry
Autumn (Mar–May)	Sow chamomile, calendula and fennel
Winter (Jun–Aug)	Prune, feed with compost and plan

MORE HERBS AND THE GARDEN

Pests and problems

Tea herbs go into the cup: no poisons. These fixes are homemade and safe.

SIGN	LIKELY CAUSE	WHAT TO DO
Leaves yellowing from the bottom up	Overwatering	Water less, improve drainage
Tiny green or black dots on shoots	Aphids	Water spray; coconut soap solution (1 tbsp/L) and rinse before harvest
Fine webs and speckled leaves	Mites (dry weather)	Mist the leaves, raise humidity
White powder on leaves	Powdery mildew (fungus)	Remove affected leaves; 1 part milk to 9 water, sprayed
Holes and eaten leaves	Caterpillars or slugs	Pick off by hand at night; ash or eggshell around
Leggy, sparse plant	Too little light or no pruning	More sun; pinch the tips
Basil flowering and turning bitter	Heat and age	Remove flowers as soon as they appear

BEFORE HARVESTING

After any treatment, wait a few days and wash the leaves well before using them for tea.

MORE HERBS AND THE GARDEN

Labels for your jars

Cut out, fill in the dates and stick them on your dried-herb jars. Two blank for your own.

Chamomile

HARVESTED ____ / ____ ·
BEST BEFORE ____ / ____

Mint

HARVESTED ____ / ____ ·
BEST BEFORE ____ / ____

Lemongrass

HARVESTED ____ / ____ ·
BEST BEFORE ____ / ____

Lemon balm

HARVESTED ____ / ____ ·
BEST BEFORE ____ / ____

Rosemary

HARVESTED ____ / ____ ·
BEST BEFORE ____ / ____

Fennel

HARVESTED ____ / ____ ·
BEST BEFORE ____ / ____

Hibiscus

HARVESTED ____ / ____ ·
BEST BEFORE ____ / ____

Ginger

HARVESTED ____ / ____ ·
BEST BEFORE ____ / ____

Calendula

HARVESTED ____ / ____ ·
BEST BEFORE ____ / ____

Lavender

HARVESTED ____ / ____ ·
BEST BEFORE ____ / ____

HARVESTED ____ / ____ ·
BEST BEFORE ____ / ____

HARVESTED ____ / ____ ·
BEST BEFORE ____ / ____

NOTES

Garden notebook

Record what you planted, when you harvested and how the tea turned out.

HERB AND SCIENTIFIC NAME

PLANTED AND HARVESTED

DRYING (METHOD AND DAYS)

AROMA ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

HERB AND SCIENTIFIC NAME

PLANTED AND HARVESTED

DRYING (METHOD AND DAYS)

AROMA ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

HERB AND SCIENTIFIC NAME

PLANTED AND HARVESTED

DRYING (METHOD AND DAYS)

AROMA ○ ○ ○ ○ ○



Thank you for brewing with us

The Botânora collection has ten guides, each devoted to one way of living with tea. Keep exploring:

01 Signature Infusions
02 The Tea Atlas
03 The Night Ritual
04 Focus & Energy
05 Iced & Cold Brew
06 Matcha at Home
08 Crafting Blends
09 Tea & Table
10 Yerba Mate

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